



[BIT703 Web Technologies](#) / [Contents](#) / Topic 5: Client-side web application development – HTML / Understanding HTML

HTML validation 30m

In earlier topics, we focused on data validation, which is an important part of any web content that involves user inputs. As a developer, you can't control how people will use your web content. Because of this, it's important to set some rules and limits to guide how the inputs work. To do this, we start by using the HTML input elements we talked about earlier and adding attributes that define the type of input expected. Later, we'll use JavaScript to improve this process even more.

Now read **<input> : The HTML Input element** (MDN Web Docs, 2025). This page is a great resource and will help you understand HTML validation better.

In the example below, we've included an input tag with several attributes. These attributes aim to meet the requirements for data type, context and size validation that we discussed earlier.



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<form action="" method="get">
  <div>
    <label for="name">Name:
  </label>
    <input
      type="text"
      id="name"
      name="name"
      required
      minlength="10"
      maxlength="50"
      size="50"
    />
  </div>

  <div>
    <label for="email">Email:
  </label>
    <input
      type="email"
      id="email"
      name="email"
      required
      minlength="10"
      maxlength="100"
      size="50"
    />
  </div>
</form>
```

Name:

Email:

Resources

1x 0.5x 0.25x

Rerun

Example 5.26



Skip to main content

Note that each `<input>` type you use will have its own range of attributes.

Complete the following task to practice your validation skills.



☒ HTML validation

Non-Assessed

Status: Done

Reset 

[Skip to main content](#)

Expand the example (5.26) provided into a **complete contact page** with a form that includes **validated fields** for all the required information. This task will help you learn how to apply HTML validation effectively to a form.

Requirements

Contact form fields (inputs):

Your form must include the following fields:

1. **Subject:** A text input for the subject of the contact message
2. **Name:** A text input for the user's name
3. **Email:** An email input to capture the user's email address
4. **Contact Number:** A telephone input for the user's phone number. You only want to accept NZ phone numbers (or only mobile phone numbers). How would you validate the field?
5. **Address:** A multiline input for the user's address (use a `<textarea>`)
6. **Message:** A multiline input for the user's message (use a `<textarea>`)

Validation and attributes:

1. Each field must include:

- The **required** attribute to ensure users cannot submit the form with empty fields.
- A suitable length validation using `minlength` and/or `maxlength` attributes.

2. Field types:

- Use appropriate type attributes for text, email, tel, and textarea inputs.
- The `textarea` fields will allow multiline text input for address and message.

3. Unique identifiers:

- Each field must have unique `id` and `name` attributes to ensure that the server-side code can process the form correctly.

4. User guidance:

- Provide meaningful **placeholder** values for fields where applicable.

[Skip to main content](#)

- Use descriptive `<label>` tags for each input field to guide users.
- Clearly indicate the expected format or restrictions of input fields (for example, 'Phone Number: must be 10 digits').

☐ I have completed this activity



How did that go? Take a look at our example: [Task: HTML validation feedback](#). You might have slight variations in how you have approached this task, but the output should be similar, and you should have covered all the key requirements.

Previous attempts ▼



The information you include in your form will be consumed by the server-side code. Even though we should NOT trust the data coming from the browser, we do need to provide the user of the page suitable guidance and help regarding what is expected to be entered into the form.



[Skip to main content](#)

In a later topic, we will revisit the `<input>` tag and an attribute known as `pattern`. This will be very useful in addition to some of the context validation.

Next, we'll explore HTML `<head>` and `<meta>` elements in more detail.



Thoughts on this page?



HTML validation

Please share your strategies for implementing HTML validation effectively. Discuss any challenges that you faced and describe the solutions you found.

B *I*  

Write your comment

 Add file

Cancel

Send

Sort by:



Jorge Andres Guerrero Giraldo 14 Jan 2026, 9:21 AM

I implement HTML validation by using appropriate input types, adding the `required` attribute to mandatory fields, and applying `minlength`, `maxlength`, or `pattern` where needed. One challenge I faced was creating validation rules that were strict enough without rejecting valid user input, especially for phone numbers. I solved this by testing real examples and providing clear labels and helper text so users understand the expected format.

Skip  to main content 



